



BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

BERNERA BRIDGE UPDATE

Statement from Comhairle nan Eilean Siar, 10th December 2020

The replacement Bernera Bridge order was placed on 27/11/20 with Mabey Bridge for a 100m span Delta Bridge in accordance with CNES design specification.

Bridge steel shall be ordered and sections manufactured from date of order placement and first payment submission. Anticipated delivery schedule as follows:

Main civil contractor commencement (12-15 weeks). **01st March 2021**

Bridge manufacture and delivery (19 weeks). **16th April 2021**

Bridge installation (35 days). **22nd May 2021**

Bridge commissioned (2 weeks following installation). **5th June 2021**

Detailed design loading to be forwarded 3-4 weeks following order placement by Mabey Bridge. Expect the design loading just before Christmas break which will allow us to progress with the detailed design of the substructures. Substructures comprise reinforced footings supported on embankment fill for the southern approach and piled foundational supports founded on rock for the north approach.

Substructure final design will require independent checking by external consultant.

Bridge superstructure and its construction sequence will also require independent checking by external consultant – Cass Hayward (bridge specialist consultants) have been appointed for this check.

Marine licence was acquired on 26/11/20 and is valid for a 12 month period. An Otter licence was acquired on 03/11/20. It is to be reviewed and moderated in on going consultation with Nature Scotland.

Planning consent comments were received 30/11/20 and await response to our mitigation responses to these comments. Environmental comments mainly concerning issues such as sediment contamination of locations adjacent to marine shellfish which have been previously addressed within the marine licence application.

Currently working on initial design of substructures in consultation with Mabey Bridge. Mabey bridge will close their office based activities on 18/12/20 but will maintain manufacturing and material ordering over the Christmas break.

Timeline provided in the above is our current best estimate for having the bridge in place however there are some hurdles to overcome in the above and we will provide updates as appropriate.

As we bring 2020 to a close here, we are saddened to report the passing of Christina Morrison, late of Bernera and Valtos. Our thoughts are with her family and friends at this difficult time.

Year endings are a time for exchanging cards and gifts and festive get-togethers, with friends and family, where we can pause and remember fondly those who are far away or no longer with us, and reminisce about what we have done throughout the year. This year has brought much uncertainty and change to us all, not least because we are so much more socially distant than usual. None of the typical events which punctuate our lives like the school carols, christmas dinner or new year ceilidh will be happening.

In our communities we've laughed, cried, clapped and zoomed together. The team here are more connected to our neighbours after countless online conversations, which have ranged from learning gaelic, to chatting with fellow crafters and to scavenger hunts with families across the Uig and Bernera area. In spite of this digital connectivity, it's really surprising how grateful the team has been for this traditional method of bringing the news and glimpses of others' lives to you and we hope that we've added a welcome connection to our fellow islanders. If you would like to get involved in the new year, please do not hesitate to get in touch.

We're signing off, wishing you all a Merry Christmas and a peaceful new year.
Nollaig Chridheil

Julia, Nat, Sam and Virginia

Contact us at: 01851 600 159

Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784

Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Or visit us online at:

www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk



POST OFFICE AND SHOP

We'd like to take this opportunity to thank Nicola for the incredible dedication to her duties at the shop. She has been a real asset to our community this year and again has been going above and beyond, by opening for late night shopping during December.

The shop and post office hours are as follows:

Mon 14th - Weds 16th Dec 12pm-5pm
 Thurs 17th Dec 12pm-7pm (Late night opening)
 Fri 18th - Sat 19th Dec 12pm-5pm
 Sunday 20th Dec CLOSED
 Mon 21st - Thurs 24th Dec 12pm-5pm

Fri 18th - Mon 28th Dec CLOSED
 Tues 29th - Thurs 31st Dec 12pm-5pm
 Fri 1st - Sun 3rd Jan CLOSED
 Mon 4th - Sat 9th Jan 12pm-5pm
 Sunday 10th Jan CLOSED



COVID-19 UPDATE

As no doubt all of you are aware, the current restrictions for Covid 19 are due to be eased slightly during the festive time. **NHS Western Isles** have the following advice and information:

The safest way to spend Christmas and the festive period is to stay within your own household, in your own home and your own local area.

Whilst the Scottish Government is providing guidance on how people can spend Christmas time with others to help prevent loneliness and isolation, advice remains that, wherever possible, you should keep in touch with friends and family members from other households through technology.

If you decide to meet in person, you should minimise the numbers and duration, and if possible meet outdoors. Consider a Christmas walk with family, rather than a meal indoors.

Currently the Scottish Government is providing advice on how to spend Christmas with other people, should you consider that necessary for your own personal circumstances. It does not mean you have to do it, and you should not feel pressured to spend Christmas in or with another household.

Travel from the Western Isles to an area with high prevalence of the virus also carries significant additional risk of transmission, which may make it safer to stay at home.



BERNERA COMMUNITY FIRESTATION ARE RECRUITING

We're recruiting retained firefighters for our local Community Fire Station.

- Do you want to have a challenging role doing something different?
- Do you want to learn new skills that can be used in a variety of jobs?
- Are you over 18 years of age?
- Are you physically fit and of good health?
- Do you have good unaided vision and colour perception?
- Are you interested in helping to provide an important emergency service for your local community?
- Are you available to respond to your local Community Fire Station for emergency call-outs?



If you can answer **YES** to these questions and would like to know more, please contact any member of Scottish Fire and Rescue Service or call **07971 008 892** for more details.

CHRISTMASES REMEMBERED

The evidence for the existence of Santa was foolproof. The glass of milk and biscuit left in the living room for him the night before was gone on Christmas morning! Who else left the train set which wasn't there on Christmas Eve! The letter to him, put up the chimney of the unlit open fire.... although it didn't appear from the top when you ran out to the garden to see, it still did not come down again! The evidence was foolproof....until, around the age of 8, I became an unbeliever.

On the way home from a Sunday School Christmas Party, I said to my father, 'Dad, now I know who Santa is'. 'Oh', he said, 'Who?'. I said. ' Jack Blair'....a local man at the church. The truth was out!

Annette, (my wife), around age 5, was on the way with her parents to get the bus to go and visit Santa in a Glasgow Store. Her father spotted a man at a window looking distressed and forlorn, and went to see. He had run out of coal, there was no means of heat, and he was helpless. The trip to see Santa ended there. They turned home, and after some time, returned: her Dad with two pails filled with coal, her Mum with a pot of soup...good King Wenceslas and the poor man gathering winter fuel comes to mind. However, it has to be said: the 5 year old was not too impressed!!

As the years have gone by, our Christmases have always been pretty good: getting the decorations up; certainly enjoying the delights of the children getting presents from 'Santa'; finding presents under the tree that weren't there the night before; enjoying wonderful Christmas Eve Carol services, (and getting engaged after one!); savouring the aromas of the turkey from the kitchen; sitting round the table waiting for Dad to carve it; and sadness too, aware of that space at the table where a loved one was last Christmas.

I can't agree with an advert on TV recently that claimed to know the real reason for Christmas: Toys. Of course 'toys' are part. Yet the attitude and actions of those, like Annette's parents, are nearer the nub of it.

And the nub?...we give, don't we, because of what has been given to us... or more correctly, Who. I'm sure we know. **John chapter 3, verse 16** tells us. You can check.

How good to give, because of the One who was given.

A very happy Christmas.

Ben and Annette Johnstone
Breaclete



BERNERA BAKES... STREUSEL-TOPPED MINCE PIES

This is a lovely Christmas recipe which I have had for a number of years. I make my own pastry usually but since it's Christmas you can take short cuts. I hope you enjoy making it and that you all have a wonderful Christmas and a brilliant year to come.

Ingredients:

500g packet sweet shortcrust pastry
411g jar of mincemeat
3oz butter
6oz self raising flour
3oz brown sugar
3oz chopped walnuts

Method:

Carefully roll out the pastry on a lightly floured surface
Cut out 24 rounds, 3" in diameter.
Place into 2 x 12 shallow bun tins.
Put 1 tsp of mincemeat into each pie.
In a bowl, rub the butter and flour until it resembles breadcrumbs.
Add the brown sugar & chopped nuts.
Top each pie with this mixture.
Bake for 25-30 mins at 180°C.
When baked, remove and allow to cool.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



THANKS TO YOU ALL

Thanks to our lovely contributors for all the brilliant content they have provided during the year. Special thanks to Caren and Colin, who have both contributed content so unstintingly, and to our fabulous local distributors, Andrea, Chrisetta, Claire, Helen, Fiona, Natalie and Sue, for making it possible to get the BN out to the community so efficiently. You have served the community brilliantly this year and we are grateful for your efforts. Thanks also to you all for supporting our work this year. The feedback has been most appreciated and we hope you are enjoying it as much as we enjoy putting it together.



CHRISTMAS WORD SEARCH

Christmas
Santa Clause
Dasher
Elf
Scrooge
Yule Log
Eggnog
Cards

Presents
Glitter
Tree
Holly
Carols
Snow
Family
Friends

Bethlehem
Cake
Angel
Star
Turkey
Sprouts
Fairy
Church



F	S	D	C	R	S	C	E	E	V	R	A	T	S
Y	A	P	A	C	F	T	A	G	L	D	V	X	X
W	C	M	R	S	H	R	O	R	G	F	T	V	P
T	S	Z	I	O	H	U	E	C	O	N	C	Q	R
S	R	C	H	L	U	E	R	I	K	L	O	I	E
A	N	U	R	O	Y	T	R	C	N	I	S	G	S
Y	N	O	R	O	L	F	S	T	H	D	N	B	E
U	R	G	W	K	O	L	C	A	R	D	S	G	N
L	O	K	L	I	E	G	Y	K	C	E	K	M	T
E	C	A	K	E	R	Y	T	U	R	K	E	Y	S
L	S	A	N	T	A	C	L	A	U	S	E	V	H
O	H	Y	R	I	A	F	G	L	I	T	T	E	R
G	C	H	R	I	S	T	M	A	S	A	Y	C	G
U	G	Y	D	B	E	T	H	L	E	H	E	M	M



Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



HISTORY QUIZ ANSWERS

1. Mary Queen of Scots
2. White Tower
3. True
4. Zimbabwe
5. 1936
6. Gannex
7. HMS Warrior
8. Dundee
9. Gutenberg Bible
10. 1917

11. Macedon
12. Dr Beeching
13. Fosse Way
14. Port Royal
15. Spanish Conquistadors
16. The Mallard
17. Tilbury
18. Britain
19. Abbotsford
20. Kirkibost

21. Scapa Flow
22. Cruden Bay
23. Lord of the Isles
24. Tasmania
25. King Arthur
26. New Town
27. Dumbarton
28. Alexander Place
29. Greyfriars Bobby
30. Greyfriars, Dumfries

COLOURING IN FUN

We've added a colouring page in addition to our usual quizzes and word searches. Many of you have children or will have younger family visiting, so get them involved.

Share pictures of your/their finished creations via **Whatsapp** or the **Daily Ceilidh facebook page**, where you will also find links to copies of the Bernera News, as well as a link to download the Christmas colouring page, and a few others too.

If you'd like extra copies delivered, please let us know by ringing or texting Julia on **07894 516 609**.



ISLAND KIDS

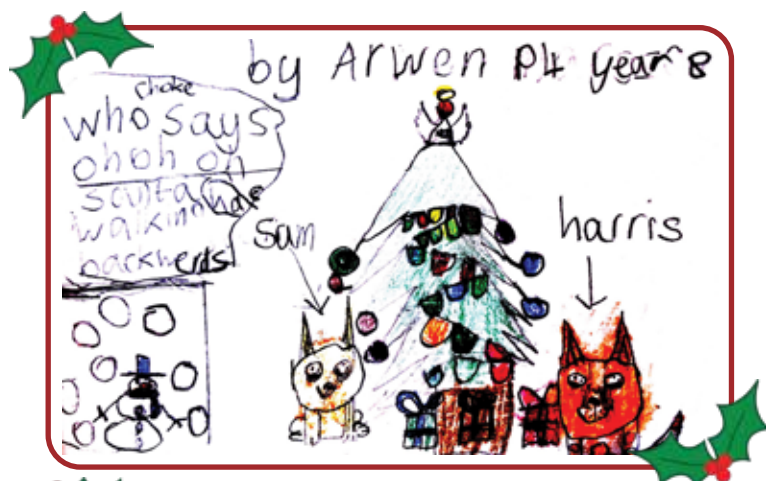
Local children across the island have sent us pictures to spread some Christmas cheer as the year closes.

We thank the children for their contributions. The team have enjoyed them so much we've raided the pantry for mince pies and mulled wine. We wish them a Merry Christmas.

Who hides in the
bakery at Christmas?
a mince spy

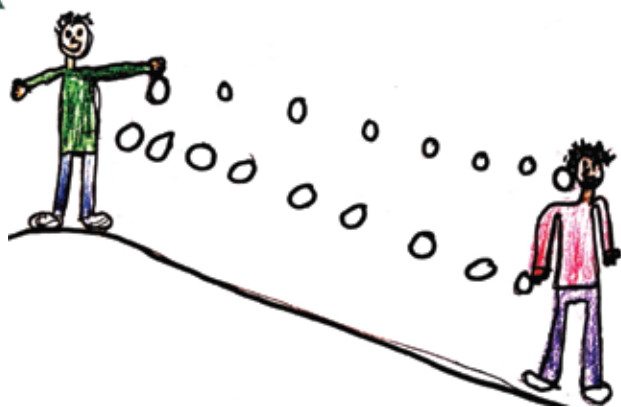


Sebastian age 11



Christmas means presents,
Christmas dinner, playing with
snow, giving presents, putting
the Christmas tree up, and
decorations.

Joseph age 11



Christmas means to me spending time
with my family opening presents with
my family making snowmen and
decorating the Christmas tree
and eating Christmas dinner.

Rebecca age 8





The whole point of Christmas to me is
Spending the Jolly Season with family and
friends singing Christmas carols.

Ava age 11

Christmas means to me a
tree with a star food, Christmas
Jumpers and stockings giving
presents to my family getting
presents and me Christopher and
Joseph outside building a snowman

Roseanne age 11



Christmas means
to me Santa on
his sleigh and making
a snowman

Carrie age 7

Christmas is special because last
year I got a quad. I like eating
food with my family. I love giving
presents and getting presents

Donald age 11



2020 - WHAT A YEAR!

We are coming to the end of an extraordinary year. A year unlike any other year we have experienced in our lives. 2020 posed so much opportunity, so many things to do. Yet, before the first quarter of this year had passed, a small virus had changed everything.

When we went to the shops in March we saw empty shelves in our Supermarkets. People fighting over packs of toilet roll and pasta. A creeping fear enveloped our families and workplaces.

Zoom was no longer the term identified to describe a fast car but a new form of relationship and dialogue, enabling individuals, families, colleagues, and communities to liaise with one another despite the restrictions of Lockdown.

The absence of physical and tangible contact impacted upon the mental wellbeing of many people, from the very young, to the most senior in our society. Clearly demonstrating that humankind was never created to live in isolation from one another. Our proximity and interaction with those closest to us being a positive and integral component of our wellbeing.

For many, if not all of us, it was a time of reflection, and for some a time of re-calibration. Reflecting upon what was past. The liberty of going where we wanted and when we wanted without reservation or restriction. Meditating on the then present. The restrictions, the challenges, and the opportunities of Lockdown. And for a considerable number of people a reflection upon their own mortality: What if 'I' become the statistic? ... What if I am the one struck down with COVID-19. What then? ... If I get sick, so sick that I may die, what then? ... Is there an eternity? Is there such a thing as a Heaven and a Hell?

It is said that man's extremity is God's opportunity. An opportunity God uses to love, bless, and comfort us through. A door through which to draw us closer to Himself.

A long time ago, a baby called 'Immanuel' was born into this world through the inspiration of the Holy Spirit. He experienced a life of extreme suffering resulting in a brutal death. Yet, out of that death, God conquered every fear, even the fear of death for His people. A people whose lives have been re-calibrated by divine grace to eternally draw nearer to God. Accompanied by the abiding presence of the One who was once dead and is now alive. Forevermore!

Immanuel, 'the God who is with us'!

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



JUST DOING MY JOB - A CHRISTMAS POEM

I'm one of Herod's Henchmen.
We don't have much to say,
We just charge through the audience
In a Henchman sort of way.

We all wear woolly helmets
To hide our hair and ears,
And Wellingtons sprayed silver
To match our tinfoil spears.

Our swords are made of cardboard
So blood will not be spilled
If we trip and stab a parent
When the hall's completely filled.

We don't look very scary,
We're mostly small and shy,
And some of us wear glasses,
But we give the thing a try.

We whisper Henchman noises
While Herod hunts for strangers,
And then we all charge out again
Like nervous Power Rangers.

Yet when the play is over
And Miss is out of breath
We'll charge like Henchmen through the hall
And scare our mums to death.

Clare Bevan

